Practical AI and Automation for Finance

Study roadmap | KLAi Professional Learning

This course is for experienced finance professionals who want to spend less time on repetitive work. You will use AI to review complex workbooks, prepare reports and presentations, and build an automation for a task you currently do manually.

Proposed format: Ten 90-minute sessions, two or three times per week. No prior coding is required. We will agree the schedule and project after the short needs assessment.

Course outline

Sessions and focus	Practical work and outcome
1 Effective and safe AI use	Compare Claude, ChatGPT and Codex on finance tasks. Learn how to give clear instructions, spot unreliable answers and protect confidential information. Save useful prompts and a data handling checklist.
2 to 3 AI with Excel	Ask Claude to review complex formulas, find inconsistencies across sheets and investigate unusual movements. Check its findings against the source records before accepting changes. Produce a workbook review with cell references and unresolved questions.
4 AI assisted finance reporting	Use AI to investigate variances, question scenario assumptions and draft management commentary. Check the figures and remove explanations the data does not support. Produce a report you can defend in a management meeting.
5 Presentation creation and quality	Use Claude or Codex to create an editable finance presentation. Replace generic wording, repetitive layouts and decorative visuals with clear findings and useful charts. Produce a five-slide briefing and a checklist for reviewing future decks.
6 Excel and connected workflow automation	Use AI to write and debug a recurring Excel task. Practise connecting apps with Zapier or Power Automate, including filters, approval steps and failed runs. Build a small automation you can use as a starting point for the capstone.
7 Power BI reporting	Use AI to help create a finance dashboard in Power BI, including DAX measures and management KPIs. Check that the calculations and filters give the right results. Produce an interactive report for reviewing financial performance.
8 Claude and Codex computer use	Practise having Claude or Codex carry out a task in a browser or desktop app, such as updating a workbook or revising slides. Learn when to intervene and which actions need your approval.
9 to 10 Workflow automation capstone	Choose a repetitive manual task and build an automation for it. Test a new batch of data and common failures, then compare the time taken with your current method. Deliver the automation and instructions for running and maintaining it.

Projects and working practices

What you should leave with

- A workbook review that identifies issues and shows where each finding came from.
- An editable finance presentation that sounds like you and explains the figures clearly.
- A finance dashboard and prompts you can reuse for analysis and reporting.
- A working automation for a repetitive task, with instructions for handling errors.

Your automation project

Start with a task that takes up time every week or month. Examples include consolidating exports, preparing reconciliation exceptions or collecting invoice details for review. We will map the current process and choose the software that fits it. You will build the automation with guidance and test it on a new batch, including missing information and duplicate records. By the end, you should be able to run it yourself, check the result and recover from a failed run. We will measure the time saved, including review and corrections.

Presentations that sound and look like your work

Give the AI a clear audience, the decision to be made and an example of the writing or design you want. Review the outline before generating the deck. Edit vague claims and stock phrases into specific findings you would say yourself. Check chart scales, text size and layout, and remove visuals that add no information. Read the slides aloud and review them at presentation size before sharing.

Handling workplace information

We will begin with sample data. The course covers what can be shared with an AI tool, how to remove identifying details and how to check storage and sharing settings. You will also practise spotting instructions hidden in documents and limiting what an AI tool can access. Reports and financial actions remain subject to your usual review and approval process.

Before the first session

Complete the online needs assessment with your preferred class times, AI tools, Excel setup and the task you would most like to automate. We will agree the project and confirm any software setup with you before class.

Complete the needs assessment | forms.gle/FGdVz8Eswpc1nvRD8

Scan to complete the needs assessment.